

Johannes Wilbertz, PhD

Imaging Biology – Project & Team Management – International Cooperation

Illkirch-Graffenstaden | +33 (0)7 66 50 27 99 | jwilbertz@gmail.com | johanneswilbertz.github.io

PROFILE

PhD in Cell Biology with over 10 years of cross-sector experience spanning academia, pharma, and biotech, specializing in advanced microscopy, cellular models, and drug discovery. Head of the Imaging Center at the IGBMC, leading photonic microscopy, image analysis, and assay development. Strong track record in project management, international consortia, target deconvolution, and strategic partnerships with industry, academia, and funding bodies. Quadrilingual (GER, EN, FR, NL).

KEY EXPERIENCE

Head of Photonic Imaging Core Facility (IR Inserm)

IGBMC, Illkirch (France) – 2026 – Present

- Center management, human and budgetary resource management, and coordination with national and international networks (France-Biolmaging and others).
- Supervision of cutting-edge equipment infrastructure (advanced microscopy, image analysis) and technology innovation selection.
- Consulting and training for users, and development of interdisciplinary collaborations.

Head of Neuroscience & R&D Director

Ksilink, Strasbourg (France) – 2020–2026

- Coordination of European brain health projects (France, Germany, Italy, Luxembourg, USA) focusing on AI-driven image analysis in patient cell-based high-throughput compound screens.
- Grant application drafting, team management (3–7 researchers), scientific and financial monitoring.
- Writing funding proposals and deliverables for funding agencies (Horizon 2020 (EU), ANR (France), BMBF (Germany)), coordination of scientific committees.
- Regular presentations to investors and partners.
- 4 publications as corresponding author, invited speaker.

Industry Postdoc – Huntington's Disease

Sanofi R&D, Strasbourg (France) – 2019–2020

- Development of a FRET assay for high-throughput screening.

- Interdisciplinary collaboration, scientific writing (1 publication as first author).

PhD – Visualization of RNA in Cellular Stress

Friedrich Miescher Institute (University of Basel/Novartis), Basel, Switzerland – 2013–2018

- Development of advanced microscopy techniques.
- Image analysis (ImageJ, Python, MATLAB), publication writing (2 as first author).

Civilian Service in Psychiatry – Patient Care

Alexianer Krankenhaus GmbH, Aachen, Germany – 2007–2008

- Patient accompaniment, ward/unit duties, assistance with therapeutic activities.

EDUCATION

PhD in Cell Biology, University of Basel (Switzerland) (2013–2018)

- **MSc in Molecular Biology & Biotechnology**, University of Groningen (Netherlands) (2013)
Internship at Harvard Medical School (USA)
- **BSc in Medical Biology**, Radboud University (Netherlands) (2011)

KEY SKILLS

- **Team & Project Management:** Planning, monitoring, international coordination
- **Scientific Writing:** Grants, reports, publications, EU deliverables
- **Imaging Biology:** Hardware application, microscope choice, assay development
- **Data Analysis & Imaging:** Python, CellProfiler, ImageJ, KNIME
- **Languages:** German (native), English (fluent), French (fluent), Dutch (fluent)

CONFERENCES & COLLABORATIONS

- Speaker at international conferences (ISSCR, Keystone, GSCN).
- Collaboration with European partners within brain health projects (France, Germany, Italy, Luxembourg, USA).

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Alvandipour K, [...], **Wilbertz JH***. Mapping human microglial morphological diversity via handcrafted and deep learning-derived image features. *iScience*. 2026.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.isci.2026.116575> (* corresponding author)

Gorgogietas V, Weiss A, [...], **Wilbertz JH***. Morphological profiling in human dopaminergic neurons identifies mitochondrial uncoupling as a neuroprotective effect. *Scientific Reports*. 2025. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-025-14735-0> (* corresponding author)

Thibaudeau A, Schmitt K, [...], **Wilbertz JH***. Pharmacological modulation of developmental and synaptic phenotypes in human SHANK3 deficient stem cell-derived neuronal models. *Translational Psychiatry*. 2024. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41398-024-02947-3> (* corresponding author)

Di Credico A, [...], **Wilbertz JH**, Di Baldassarre A. Machine learning identifies phenotypic profile alterations of human dopaminergic neurons exposed to bisphenols and perfluoroalkyls. *Scientific Reports*. 2023. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-023-49364-y>

Vuidel A, [...], **Wilbertz JH***. Machine learning-aided multidimensional phenotyping of Parkinson's disease patient stem cell-derived midbrain dopaminergic neurons. *Stem Cell Reports*. 2022. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.stemcr.2022.09.001> (* corresponding author)

Wilbertz JH, [...], Calamini B. Time-resolved FRET screening identifies small molecular modifiers of mutant Huntingtin conformational inflexibility in patient-derived cells. *SLAS Discovery*. 2021. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.slasd.2021.10.005>

Ross NT, Lohmann F, [...], **Wilbertz JH**, [...], Chao JA, Beckwith REJ. CPSF3-dependent pre-mRNA processing as a druggable node in AML and Ewing's sarcoma. *Nature Chemical Biology*. 2019. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41589-019-0424-1>

Wilbertz JH, Voigt F, Horvathova I, Roth G, Zhan Y, Chao JA. Single-molecule imaging of mRNA localization and regulation during the integrated stress response. *Molecular Cell*. 2019. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.molcel.2018.12.006>

Halstead JM*, Lionnet T*, **Wilbertz JH***, Wippich F*, Ephrussi A, Singer RH, Chao JA. An RNA biosensor for imaging the first round of translation from single cells to living animals. *Science*. 2015. <https://doi.org/10.1126/science.aaa3380> (* denotes co-first authors)